Chloé Breton

PhD Candidate in Economics

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Paris, France

French citizenship

Research Profile

PhD candidate in economics at CREST and Télécom Paris (Institut Polytechnique de Paris), defence expected in May 2027. Applied microeconomics, with a focus on telework, consumer mobility and local consumption, based on very granular data made available through a partnership between Télécom Paris, Insee and Cartes Bancaires (CB). The thesis has two aims: research of high academic standard, and helping Insee extend its use of CB card data in official statistics. Attached to Insee's Data Science Innovation Unit, working with a member of the team on the coverage and comparability of this source, which depends in particular on CB's market share.

Research Interests

Applied econometrics · Industrial organisation · Urban economics · Spatial economics · Consumer mobility and retail externalities

Working Papers & Work in Progress

"The Consumer City Revisited: Consumption Responses to Real-Time Population Presence"

David Bounie, Chloé Breton, John Galbraith, Gabrielle Gambuli

Job Market Paper · Working Paper, March 2026 · Submitted to REStat

Combines high-frequency mobile phone location data with card transaction records for the Lyon metropolitan area to estimate the elasticity of transactions with respect to the number of people present in each of over one thousand zones (Poisson pseudo-maximum likelihood). The elasticity varies across time and space, with a peak on Saturday midday and lower values in peripheries than in urban cores. Spatial frictions reduce transaction flows with distance from home, and essential goods such as food retail respond more than discretionary sectors.

"The Impact of Telework on Local Consumption: Evidence from Mobile Phone and Transaction Data"

Gabrielle Gambuli, David Bounie, Chloé Breton, Etienne Come

Insee Working Paper (Documents de travail) No. 2026-16, September 2026 · Submitted to JEEA

Uses mobile phone and card transaction data for the Lyon metropolitan area to identify two demand shocks from telework: a 1 pp rise in teleworking presence raises local spending by about 1%, while a 1 pp drop in on-site presence lowers it by about 1.3%. The net effect on weekday in-store spending is small and not significant; spending shifts toward residential suburbs.

"Closure Externalities and Trip Chains"

Chloé Breton

Work in progress

Uses twelve months of card transaction data (May 2024 – April 2025) from the Centre-Val de Loire region to test whether the complementarities revealed by trip chains have economic content: when a store closes, do consumers who used to combine it with another store in the same outing keep visiting the surviving store? Chains are observed directly at the level of the card and the establishment, whereas the literature typically calibrates them on surveys or infers them from aggregates. Event study comparing cards that chained the surviving store with the closing store to cards that chained it with a comparable store that stayed open. Visits to the surviving store decline after the closure.

"Shop Externality Revealed through the Consumer Journey"

Chloé Breton, Laura Gaimard

Insee Analyses (four pages) · forthcoming, April 2027

Institutional companion note to "Closure Externalities and Trip Chains", based on its descriptive results and extended to metropolitan France with CB card transaction data: share of chained transactions and spending, most frequent pairs of store types, and differences between urban and rural areas.

"Do Anchor Stores Generate Spillovers?"

Marie-Laure Allain, Chloé Breton

Work in progress

Studies the June 2022 closure of a large cultural retail store in Paris using weekly card transaction data (CB) for establishments within one kilometre, matched to the Insee SIRENE register. Establishments closer to the closed store are compared with those closer to another store of the same chain that stayed open, in difference-in-differences and triple-difference designs. Competing cultural retailers nearby gain transactions after the closure; effects on complementary sectors (food and beverage, other retail, services) are smaller.

Education

PhD in Economics – Télécom Paris, CREST, IP Paris — 2023 – present

Thesis: Empirical Essays on Spatial Connectivity and Retail Activity (working title)

Advisors: [David Bounie] · [John Galbraith]

MSc in Economics – Université Paris 1 Panthéon-Sorbonne — 2021

Research Experience

Doctoral Researcher, CREST, Télécom Paris — 2023 – present

Insee, Data Science Innovation Unit

Cartes Bancaires (CB), Data Science Unit

Academic research on granular card transaction data made available through the Télécom Paris–Insee–CB partnership. With Insee's Data Science Innovation Unit, work on the coverage and comparability of card data in official statistics. Interface between the academic team, Insee and CB.

Research Assistant – Applied econometrics projects — 2022

[Telecom]

Teaching & Supervision

École Polytechnique – Introduction to Industrial Organisation (Graduate tutorial) — Fall 2024, 2025

22h per year, 44h in total. Firm behaviour, strategic interactions, game theory, mergers, collusion, vertical integration

ENSAE – Advanced Microeconomics (tutorial, 2 groups of 6h, 12h in total) — Winter 2026

Télécom Paris – Data Analysis in Economics 2: Applied Econometrics (Graduate tutorial) — Winter 2024

22h. Econometric tools for large-scale data; supervision of empirical projects

ENSAE – Accounting and Financial Analysis (Undergraduate tutorial) — Spring 2025, Spring 2026

12h per year in 2 groups, 24h in total. Accounting documents, financial analysis, investment criteria, firm valuation

Co-supervision – Three interns 2022, 2025

M2, Télécom Paris (2022) · M2, ENSAE (2025) · M1, École Polytechnique (2025)

Service

Organiser – Research retreat, Economics Department, Télécom Paris 2024, 2025

Organisation support – Paris Conference on Digital Economics, Télécom Paris 2024

Conferences & Summer Schools

3EN – École d'été d'économie numérique (AFREN), Nice Jun 2026

Advances in Spatial and Network Modelling for Policymaking (JRC), Seville May 2026

MNO-MINDS Final Conference, OECD, Paris Sep 2025

3EN – École d'été d'économie numérique (AFREN) Jul 2025

AFSE Annual Conference – ENS Paris-Saclay Jun 2025

SEW 2025 – International Workshop on Spatial Econometrics & Statistics, Saint-Étienne Jun 2025

BSE Summer Forum Workshop, Barcelona Jun 2025

Digital Economics Summer School Jun 2024

Young Economists Seminar Sep 2023

All presentations: "Exploring Consumer Mobility and Shopping Externalities." Participation funded by Télécom Paris and the Chaire Finance Digitale.

Skills

Programming	R · Python · SQL · Spark · DuckDB · Git · LaTeX
Data	Large-scale transaction data · Mobile phone data · Spatial / GIS data · Official statistics · Econometrics of big data
Languages	French (native) · English (fluent) · German (conversational)

Last updated: October 31, 2026

References

David Bounie
Professor, Télécom Paris (thesis advisor)

John Galbraith
Professor, McGill University (thesis advisor)

Marie-Laure Allain
Professor, École Polytechnique (co-author)

Mélina Hillion
Deputy Head, SSP Lab, Insee